

Your half — the client

You are Marisa Del Rio, senior producer at Pike & Rowan.

A Chordential discovery call · HALVARD, “Long Way Home”
· agency: Pike & Rowan.

Every name and brand here is invented. Nothing in this call describes real client work.

HOW TO RUN IT

1. Two readers, one script each. **Both are numbered the same**, and the other person's lines are printed so you never lose your place.
2. Schedule the call in Chordential so the notetaker joins, then start the Zoom.
3. **Read at talking pace, not reading pace.** Pause, overlap, say “um”. It is being tested against speech — a flat recitation tests nothing that matters.
4. About **10–12 minutes**. Don't rush the read-back near the end; it is doing real work.

1 · JON

Marisa, thanks for making time. Before we start — who's with us today, and how does each of you touch this project?

2 • YOU

Just me today. I'm Marisa Del Rio, senior producer at Pike & Rowan. I'm running production on this one end to end.

3 • JON

And who isn't here who has an opinion on the music?

4 • YOU

Our creative director, Aziz Barr. And someone on the HALVARD side will have to bless it, but that's later.

5 • JON

I've got a notetaker running so I'm listening rather than typing. Is that alright with you?

6 • YOU

That's fine.

7 • JON

I'll ask about the work, the sound, the plan, and then some boring commercial questions at the end. You'll have a written summary today. Does that work?

8 • YOU

Works. I've got about forty minutes.

9 • JON

Before the music — what is this campaign trying to do for the business?

10 • YOU

HALVARD has been a technical outdoor brand for twenty years and it reads as cold. This is the autumn brand film, and the job is to make people feel something about the brand rather than about the jacket. If we get it right, it shifts how people talk about them.

11 • JON

And how will you know it worked?

12 • YOU

Honestly? If the comments are about the film and not about the price.

13 • JON

What is the music's job inside the film specifically?

14 • YOU

It carries the whole thing. There's no voiceover and barely any dialogue — a woman walking home over about two minutes, the seasons changing around her. The music is the narration.

15 • JON

Talk me through every version you need. Master, cutdowns, socials, stems.

16 • YOU

A two-minute master for the film. Then thirty and fifteen second cutdowns for broadcast, and vertical versions for social.

17 • JON

How many verticals, and do you need stems on all of them or just the master?

18 • YOU

Three verticals. Stems just on the master — our editor likes to duck things himself.

19 • JON

Walk me through how it should feel across the piece, start to end.

20 • YOU

It starts as almost nothing — one instrument, quite bare. It should feel like the cold. Then it warms, and by the last thirty seconds it's full and it lands somewhere hopeful. But not triumphant. Please, not triumphant.

21 • JON

Is there a turn anywhere, or does it hold one feeling throughout?

22 • YOU

There's a turn about eighty seconds in, when she reaches the ridge.

23 • JON

What are you listening to for this? And is there anything you've been sent that's the wrong direction?

24 • YOU

We've been living in Johannsson and Hildur Gudnadottir. Everyone keeps sending us Sigur Ros and it is the wrong direction — too weightless. And the temp track on the cut right now is a licensed indie thing that we all hate.

25 • JON

Which part of the Johannsson are you reacting to — the instrumentation, or the feeling?

26 • YOU

The restraint. He leaves space.

27 • JON

What is the air date, and when do you need final delivery to hit it?

28 • YOU

It goes live October the third. We'd want final delivery three weeks before that, so around the twelfth of September.

29 • JON

Are those the same date for everything, or do socials come later?

30 • YOU

Socials can come a week after the master.

31 • JON

And is anything upstream of us still moving, like the edit lock?

32 • YOU

We lock picture on the twenty-second of August. That should hold.

33 • JON

What is the approved number for music?

34 • YOU

We're around sixty.

35 • JON

Is that all-in including the licence, and is it a ceiling or a target?

36 • YOU

The approved music number is fifty-five to sixty-five thousand, and it is a hard ceiling. That's inclusive of the licence.

37 • JON

Who gives final approval on this, and how many times will they see it?

38 • YOU

Aziz signs off creatively. He'll see it twice — a first pass and a final.

39 • JON

Is anyone else in the room whose opinion changes the outcome?

40 • YOU

Sorry — I should correct myself. Aziz signs off on our side, but final approval is Tom Vasquez, HALVARD's brand director. He sees it once, at the end.

41 • JON

That's worth having straight. So Aziz is our day-to-day, and Tom is the one who can send it back?

42 • YOU

Yes. And Tom is not a music person, so make it obvious.

43 • JON

Tell me how the brand shows up. What is it careful about?

44 • YOU

They're careful about anything that reads as luxury — they're a working brand. And music has let them down before. They licensed something two years ago that turned up in a car ad three months later, and it was embarrassing.

45 • JON

How does your side actually work — who moves paper, and how fast?

46 • YOU

Our legal is slow. Assume three weeks for any contract. And procurement will want a purchase order before anything starts.

47 • JON

Right — the boring bit. How long do you need the usage to run?

48 • YOU

Twelve months from first air, I think.

49 • JON

Is that from delivery, or from first air?

50 • YOU

From first air.

51 • JON

When that term is up, do you expect to renew, or does it lapse?

52 • YOU

I'd expect we renew if it performs. Can we agree the renewal price now?

53 • JON

We can, and it is cheaper to. Where does this run — US only, or worldwide?

54 • YOU

North America to start. There's a chance it extends to the UK in the spring, but that is not committed.

55 • JON

Do you need any exclusivity, category or otherwise?

56 • YOU

Category exclusive for outdoor apparel, for the term. That one is non-negotiable after what happened.

57 • JON

Is there an expectation about who holds publishing?

58 • YOU

I genuinely don't know. I'd have to ask legal.

59 • JON

That's fine — I'll put a standard position in the summary and your legal can push back. Will this need PRO registration, and do you have a cue sheet process?

60 • YOU

Yes, we file cue sheets. Our post house handles it.

61 • JON

What does your payment schedule usually look like?

62 • YOU

Net sixty from invoice.

63 • JON

Is there a deposit, and what triggers the final invoice?

64 • YOU

We can do a deposit on signature. Final on delivery and acceptance.

65 • JON

Any requirement about union or non-union players?

66 • YOU

No requirement. We've used live players before and liked it.

67 • JON

One more thing — you said three verticals earlier. Is that still right?

68 • YOU

Actually, make it four. There's a fourth placement we just picked up.

69 • JON

Noted — four verticals. Let me play back what I've got, and stop me where I'm wrong. Two-minute master; thirty and fifteen second cutdowns; four verticals; stems on the master only. Live October third, final delivery September twelfth, picture lock August twenty-second. Fifty-five to sixty-five all-in, hard ceiling. Twelve months from first air, North America, category exclusive in outdoor apparel. Net sixty with a deposit on signature. Tom Vasquez approves, Aziz day to day. Publishing still open.

70 • YOU

That's all right. One correction — the fifteen second cutdown might become a six. I'll confirm.

71 • JON

I'll scope both and we'll drop one. What haven't I asked about that I should have?

72 • YOU

Whether you need the stems by instrument or by group. Group is fine.

73 • JON

Good catch — that's a real difference. Has anything gone wrong on a project like this before?

74 • YOU

The car ad thing. And once we got a track that was beautiful and forty seconds too short to cut down.

75 • JON

You'll get a written summary today. Who else should be on it?

76 • YOU

Copy Aziz. Not Tom yet.

77 • JON

And what's the best way to reach you if something needs a quick answer?

78 • YOU

Email, or my mobile — it's in my signature.

79 • JON

Thanks Marisa. This was a good one.

80 • YOU

Thanks Jon.

Staying in character

- **You are the client, not the tester. Don't help.** If Jon doesn't ask something, don't volunteer it — half of what this measures is what a real call loses.
- **Two of your lines are corrections, and they matter.** At turn 40 you correct who signs off; at turn 70 you correct the cutdown length during the read-back. Deliver both as genuine afterthoughts, not as cues.
- **At turn 58 you don't know the answer.** Say so plainly and move on. A question that gets no answer has to survive the call as an open question.
- **Improvise at the edges** — an “um”, a false start, a different word — as long as the facts land. Speech that sounds like speech is the point.